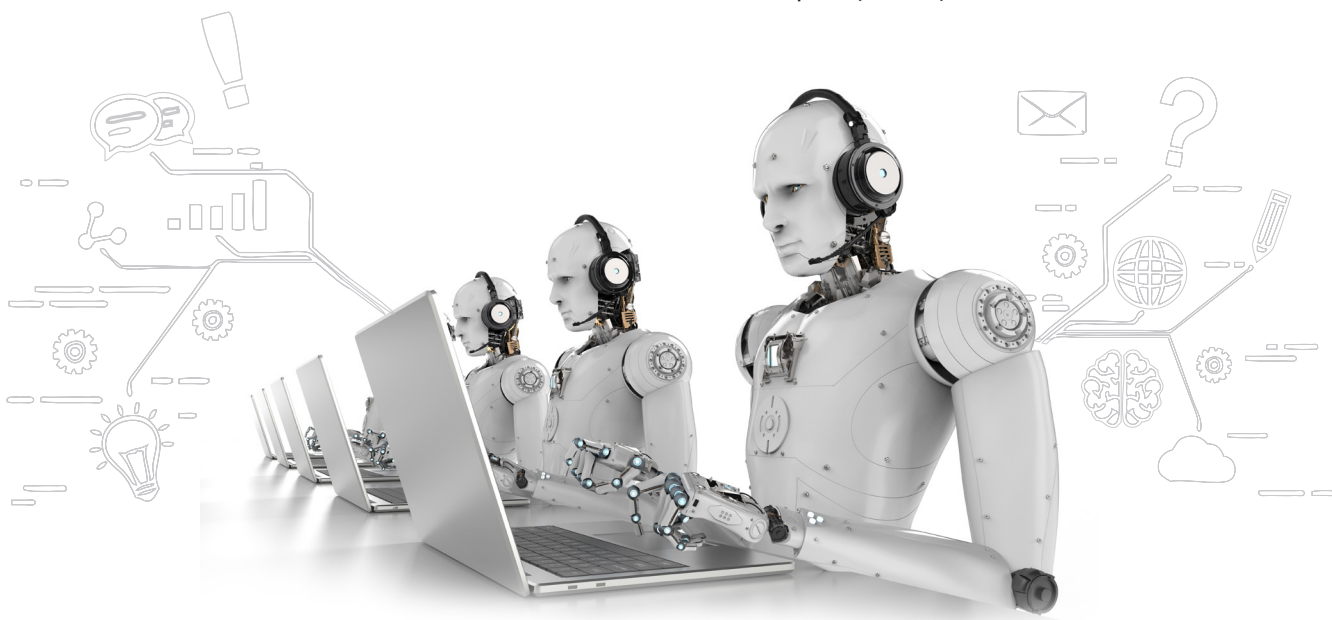


Keep IT Services Up and Running with AI Based Digital Assistants

There are many ways AI based digital assistants help in IT operations. Traditionally, they have been deployed to improve helpdesk services. Today you can use them to reduce the mean time to repair (MTTR) of an IT service.



Enterprises deploy many IT services such as microservices, line of business services, virtual desktop services, and database services for their customers, business groups and employees. In case critical IT services break down, there is a huge negative impact in terms of enterprise revenue, and loss of productivity and reputation. Many of these services are hosted in the enterprise data centre, and can go down due to infrastructure, process, or human failures. Even in the case of public cloud hosting, enterprise integration is a weak link in the chain.

Need of the hour

When a critical IT service is down, IT teams are under enormous pressure to

restore it as quickly as possible. Faster root cause analysis is the need of the hour. Teams from various verticals — infrastructure, security, network, storage, and other relevant teams — get into the war room to find the root cause. Tons of logs, event sources, and traces are collected. It is a humongous task for the team to analyse huge data in a short time under panic conditions. Teams need reliable, intelligent, and faster tools to analyse data and provide dependable conclusions. Artificial intelligence based assistants can help in this situation.

Table 1 lists the typical questions teams need to answer during root cause analysis of IT operations after a critical service becomes unavailable.

AI powered digital assistants

A digital assistant, also called virtual assistant, is an application program that understands natural language voice or chat commands and completes tasks for the user. In the context of root cause analysis or IT operations, the tasks are complex. To execute these tasks, virtual assistants adopt artificial intelligence.

Administrators, instead of logging in to individual layer consoles, pulling data manually and analysing it, can take the help of digital assistants. These assistants can do all the heavy lifting for IT staff. They assist in accelerating the process, thereby reducing mean time to repair (MTTR).